

# FASTER ADOBE

## Speed up Adobe products and quick Photoshop tutorials

### Some tips to speed up Adobe products

#### Allocating Scratch Disks

Scratch disks are portions of the hard disk used by Photoshop or Premier Pro to run itself. When working with large image files, for instance, when you add layers and perform editing operations on it, these states are stored in this virtual memory called Scratch Disk. To set your scratch disk select **Edit > Preferences > Plug-Ins** and select Scratch Disks. You should choose a drive which has the most free space, as you do not want Photoshop or Premier Pro to prevent you from doing your work, if your scratch disk is full. Majority of the professionals install specific fast access drives just to be used as scratch disks.

#### Defragmenting your drives

When images are saved and resaved on the disk they get fragmented which means that instead of being stored in one single location, the information is broken into bits and stored in several locations. This file fragmentation slows down the opening and saving of files which affects the performance. So it is

imperative to defrag your hard drive every once in a while.

**To defragment a drive in Windows XP:** Click **Start>All Programs>Accessories>System Tools>Disk Defragmenter**. Choose the drive to be defragmented and then select the Defragment button.

**To defragment a drive in Mac OS X:** Despite the fact that the latest version of Mac OS X contains automatic defragmentation of files smaller than 20MB, most Apple users prefer to defrag their drives with third-party utilities.

#### RAM percentages

Photoshop will share the system RAM with the underlying OS and programs running at that point of time when Photoshop is open. Under **Edit>Preferences**, there is a slider which allows you to select the amount of RAM Photoshop can use. Under ideal conditions setting a higher percentage should translate into speedier Photoshop, right? Not really.

If the percentage is kept higher, then Photoshop and your OS may need to move information between the faster RAM memory and slower hard drive memory. This is called



Tweak the Angle, Distance and Speed of the Drop shadow in Layer Style dialog box

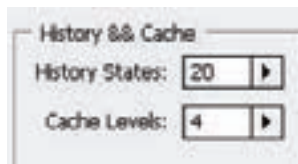
page swapping and that can end up slowing down Photoshop.

If you have 2GB of RAM keep the allocation at 50 to 60 per cent whereas anything more than 2GB you can go up to 70 per cent.

#### Other quick tips

Always have only Photoshop open while using it and close all other applications that run in the background as they will tend to slow down the performance of Photoshop since they sip a lot of the CPU processing power.

Minimise the number of history states as each successive edit in the history state is stored in the palette. It uses some memory resources. Go to **Edit>Preferences** and under the



History states



Before : Just a car speeding down the highway



After : The car seems to come out of the photo